Poornima Patel

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EDUCATION

Drexel University ***Anticipated Graduation: June 2029***
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science ***GPA: 3.48***
Minor: Data Science | Concentrations: AI & Machine Learning, Computer Security & Privacy
Relevant Coursework: Computing and Informatics Design I, II & III, Calculus I, II & III, Linear Algebra, Computer Programming I & II, Intro to Data Science, Intro to SE & Development, Systems Design and Architecture, Data Structures & Algorithms, Math Foundations of Computer Science, Advanced Prog. Tools and Techniques, Intro to Business Statistics I & II, Probability & Statistics

SKILLS

Languages: HTML5, CSS3, Python, Java, C, C++, JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Dart, MySQL, R, Racket
Environments: IntelliJ, VS Code, Android Studio, Xcode, Node.js, Bash
Tools, Frameworks, Platforms & Libraries: Git (GitHub & GitLab), Flutter, React 18, React Native, Microsoft 365, Excel, TeamDynamix, Active Directory, Yarn, Pandas
Cloud & DevOps: Docker, Google Cloud Platform (Cloud Run), FastAPI, REST APIs, Claude/Anthropic API
Methodologies: Agile, Scrum, Test-Driven Development (TDD), Object-Oriented Programming (OOP), Kanban
Security & Compliance: PCI DSS, TPRM, CMMC, Tenable, Shodan, Bitsight

WORK EXPERIENCE

Jr. IT Security Analyst, Drexel University Mar 2026 - Sep 2026
- Led Bug Bounty analysis using Tenable and Shodan to identify exposed attack surfaces
- Led monthly vulnerability management by analyzing Tenable scans across departments to drive remediation
- Collaborated on Third-Party Risk Management efforts, evaluating vendor security controls and documenting findings for stakeholders using BitSight and TeamDynamix; Led co-op hiring and collaborated directly with the CISO

The Triangle IT - Drexel University Student Newspaper Jan 2025 - Present
- Supported a self-hosted IT stack (ticketing, SSO, monitoring, backups) across 14+ Docker containers on a Proxmox host; confirmed automatic recovery on reboot
- Diagnosed an Elasticsearch AVX2 compatibility issue by troubleshooting across hypervisor, VM, and container layers (SSH, Proxmox/Docker CLI), scoping a config fix vs. hardware upgrade
- Onboarded and offboarded staff in Active Directory, including account creation, password resets, and group permissions

Course Assistant - CI 101 Sep 2026 - Present
- Mentor students in HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Linux commands, Git/GitLab, and Tux (Drexel's Linux Server) through office hours and weekly labs
- Guide teams through web development, cryptography, networking, and cybersecurity CTF challenges
- Grade assignments using standardized rubrics and provide actionable feedback to improve student learning

PROJECT & RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Consumer Complaint Classifier - LLM-Powered API Aug 2026 - Sep 2026
- Built and deployed a Python live NLP API using Claude to classify consumer complaints into 5 financial categories, reaching ~80% accuracy on a test set
- Sourced and processed a 160K+ row Kaggle dataset, engineering prompts and validating Claude's output vs. ground-truth labels
- Built a FastAPI REST endpoint for on-demand HTTP requests, containerized with Docker, and deployed to Google Cloud Run

Budget Dragon - Student Budgeting App May 2025 - Sep 2025
- Developed a cross-platform finance app using Flutter and Dart with an object-oriented design, tailored for Drexel students to manage tuition, dining, and living expenses
- Collaborated in an Agile team of four during a three-course freshman sequence to iteratively design, prototype, and implement core budgeting features
- Designed intuitive UI with bar chart visualizations to provide clear insights into spending patterns

Language Models with Iterative Self-Attention (LISA) - VIP Research Assistant Jun 2026 - Present
- Refactoring and modularizing a transformer architecture (iterative Hopfield-attention mechanism with eigenspectrum regularization) to improve code maintainability, readability, and reusability
- Packaging an existing PyTorch research codebase for public release on Hugging Face, enabling adoption by external researchers and engineers
- Making advanced attention-mechanism research accessible to the broader ML community through open-source tooling

CERTIFICATIONS

- ARCX Foundation Level Threat Intelligence Analyst, Cisco Intro to Cybersecurity, Cisco Networking Basics, Bash & Command Line 101, Columbia+ Prompt Engineering & Programming with OpenAI